'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Spring 2020

Enjoying Our Amenities in the "New Normal"

by Jason Géno, CMA President

Trails are ready for Hiking!

Living on Capitol Hill in DC, I miss the daily hikes at Coolfont. I feel rejuvenated when I finish my walks through the forest, or even around the loop of CMA. Nature has positive effects on mental health and there are many beautiful places to enjoy at Coolfont Mountainside. Our friend and neighbor, Craig Deane, just finished re-blazing the CMA trails, so we should take a moment to enjoy the outdoors and get some exercise.

Tennis Courts are Open

After speaking with health officials, there was no clear indication that closing tennis courts should be a mandate. Therefore, we are leaving the tennis courts open, and we are adding 6 foot distance reminder signs at several of our public spaces.

Status of CMA Pool

There has been a lot of discussion regarding opening of the Coolfont pool this summer. As I write this article (April 28), I have instructed our site manager to prepare the pool for opening; however, the date of the opening will be dependent on ensuring safety of CMA members and pool staff. We will be working with the local health officials to determine the safest procedures to have in place prior to opening. I will send out communication through the CMA Google Group over the next several weeks, as we gain a better understanding on how to deal with this "new normal."

Given the uncertainty around us, it is best to continue to be vigilant regarding practicing our social distancing of at least 6 feet apart, no large gatherings, and washing hands before and after enjoying the amenities.

Be Safe and Stay Well

UPCOMING EVENTS

Board of Directors Meeting	May 9, 10:00 am	Teleconference
Potluck Dinner	May 9, 6:00 pm	Cancelled
Pool Opens	May 23	Details via Google Group
Memorial Day Event	May 23	Details via Google Group
Board of Directors Meeting	June 13, 10:00 am	Teleconference/CMA Office
Board of Directors Meeting	August 8, 10:00 am	CMA Office

Hi Neighbors!

We just finished building our house on the property we bought many years ago on Bobcat Lane. We live in Columbia, MD and look forward to spending as much time as possible on the mountainside. Right now we are unable to move into the cabin because of travel restrictions and closures. However, as soon as this is all over, we look forward to meeting all of you and enjoying all our wonderful community has to offer. Stay well!

Steve Strauss and Bess Altwerger (Q-6)

Neighborhood Watch

by Cathy Level, Chair

As the community waits in quiet anticipation for everyone's return, Neighborhood Watch has opted to increase presence in the community by implementing additional patrols. Please know we will keep you informed of anything out of the ordinary. We plan to continue the additional patrols throughout the governor's "stay at home" order and until a return to a most welcome sense of renewed normalcy. If you have any specific security-related concerns, please contact Cathy Levey at mccm2012@hotmail.com or (cell) 410-718-6716 or (home) 304-258-5481.

Wishing everyone safety and health as we face these current challenges.

Please monitor the CMA website and/or Google Group emails for information and updates on the status of the community pool, sports courts, and playground equipment.

Policy Resolutions

In recent months, the Board has approved written policies for the management of assessment and water/sewer accounts. The **Delinquent Assessment Policy**, approved in March, includes procedures for collection of overdue assessments. The **Leak Adjustment Policy**, also approved in March, outlines the requirements and calculations for leak adjustments for water/sewer bills. The **Delinquent Water & Sewer Policy**, pending approval at the May meeting, outlines procedures for collection of overdue water and sewer accounts.

While these Policies present no major changes to how CMA manages these accounts, they provide a written explanation of the Association's policies and procedures.

Owners are encouraged to review the full text on the CMA website, under Owner/Documents. Copies will also be available for on-site review at the CMA Office, by appointment.

Photo Credits

Rosemary Bigelow (O-4): pp. 1, 8 CMA Entrance; Craig Deane (T-2): p. 2 Bluebells, p. 6 Morel Mushrooms, p. 7 Wood Anemone (Windflower), Rattlesnake Lily, Violets; Tom Holz (F-1): p. 3 Water Facilities; Cathy Levey (A-6): p. 4 Daffodils, p. 7 Forsythia.



Get Your Feet Wet: The CMA Water System

by Joe Van Meter (K-16)

The Real Value of Your Home

Surprisingly, the number of rooms, architecture, or ambiance of your home – or even the assessed value of your unimproved lot are not the only determinants in the value of your investment. While these factors influence the market value, your home or lot would be worth significantly less without reliable, safe, and sanitary water and sewer services. We're fortunate that CMA's services are reliable and high quality. Otherwise, you might be unable to use, rent, or sell your property among the trees, animals, and fresh air.

From the Well to Your Home

CMA's water system is divided into two water systems – The North System and the South System. Each system has a well, drilled many years ago by the developer. Both are over 200 feet deep and tap into large underground aquifers. Water is pumped to the surface by large pumps that deliver it to a settling tank where it is chlorinated and treated to remove impurities, making it safe for human consumption. From there, the water is pumped to reservoirs for storage and delivery. The systems use gravity to deliver water to your home, so the reservoirs are located "up the hill" from the homes they service.

Maintaining the Systems

Our water and sewer systems are wholly owned by CMA and are independent of any other systems. The wells, pumps, reservoirs, treatment systems, and the network of underground pipes, meters, regulators, and valves that deliver your water all require ongoing monitoring and maintenance. Our aging infrastructure requires frequent updates and repairs to continue to deliver fresh, clean drinking water and reliable sewer services.

Prior to 2019, all management and operation was performed by your CMA neighbors, all volunteers. For years they donated many hours and days, providing professional-level services at no charge to CMA owners. Their work protected your investment in your property at CMA. Even today, CMA volunteers still help maintain these systems, managing and working with contractors that conduct most daily operations.

In 2019, the Board contracted with the Warm Springs Public Service District (WSPSD) to provide operational and maintenance support to fulfill CMA's obligations to owners and to meet regulatory requirements. WSPSD is well-placed to provide support as it is staffed with certified water and sewer system managers – the same personnel that operate many systems for Morgan County. The contract and oversight of the system are the responsibility of volunteers on the CMA Board and Chair of Water and Sewer, Cathy Levey (A-6).

Meeting the Standard

CMA's utility systems are a Public Utility under the regulatory control of the West Virginia Public Service Commission (WVPSC). While CMA fully owns and operates the systems, the WVPSC regulates the rates, processes, and most operational procedures. WV Code of State Rules 150, Section 7 provides guidance to operators and customers of water utilities. Although it does not address all operational matters, it does cover billing, metering, and how a utility interacts with its customers. Additionally, the utility is issued a license to operate by the WV Department of Health (WVDOH), who can revoke the license if the utility's operations do not adhere to strict DOH guidance.

(Continued on page 6.)



Clockwise from top left: North Reservoir, R Reservoir, South Pump House, South Reservoir. Center: North Well.



New Email for Site Manager

Please note this new email address for the CMA Site Manager, Holly Malcomb of Almost Heaven Property Management:
cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-671-0882

Where Do My Assessment Go?

by Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer

Owners often ask why they have to pay what is commonly known as the member assessment when they move into a homeowner association. While "assessment" is the technically correct term, the fact is that they are actually property maintenance fees. When the collective buying power of the entire association is factored in, they prove to be a real bargain for individual owners. These fees cover exterior maintenance of facilities, snow removal, landscaping, utilities, recreation facilities, and more. They also include savings for future big-ticket items like roofs, repaving, and other major repairs—which means owners will not be hit unexpectedly with a special assessment when these large expenditures are required.

Here at Coolfont, about 45% of assessments go to help fund the Water & Sewer utility. In the future, we hope that Water & Sewer will require less funding from the Association. The Board is also working to shore up capital reserves for Water & Sewer - to provide funding for future infrastructure repairs and projects.

Trails Maintenance - 1.4%
Utilities - 1.6%
Committees - 2.0%
Snow Plowing - 2.4%
Bookkeeping/Legal Fees - 2.6%
Capital Reserves - 3.7%
Barn/Entrance Maintenance - 4.3%
Association Business - 4.4%
Taxes and Insurance - 4.8%
Site Management - 5.7%
Roads Maintenance - 10.5%
Pool Operations - 11.4%
Funding to Water & Sewer - 45.0%



Percentages based on 2020 Budget

CMA Website



The CMA website has tons of great information for residents. You'll find the Community Calendar, with the upcoming events and information as it's available. Under Member Services, you'll find information about the Site Manager, snow plowing, and water/sewer service.

You can read through all the years of newsletters, check out Board Meeting minutes, and/or read the governing documents in the Owners/Documents area. There are also forms for the DACC and Firewise. We've included a list of contractors your CMA neighbors have used and recommend. You'll find all this, and more, at:

www.coolfontmountainside.com.

Click on Owners and enter the username: **owner** and password: **coolfont**.

Directory Assistance



Please keep your Membership Directory current by updating the information noted below. We will also update the PDF of the directory available on the CMA website at Owners/Documents.

H-1 Paul & Bryane Soni
bryanesoni@yahoo.com 941-306-5035
Part time residents

K-4 Nathaniel Shalom & Jamie Hittman
nshalom1@gmail.com 301-300-3018
oncloudvii@gmail.com 443-629-6996
Part time residents

K-12 Iris J Melton
zijmelton@gmail.com 617-894-0619
"The Growlery" Full time resident

L-2 Elaine Geiger
geiger_elaine@hotmail.com 443-845-4324
"Tiger Den" Part time resident

From the Archives - Nov. 10, 1992

BERKELEY SPRINGS, W. VA.

Outdoor Gores get lost in woods

The environmental vice president-elect lost touch with his environment during a weekend trip.

Al Gore and his wife, Tipper Gore, were hiking Saturday at Coolfont Resort, in woods about 50 miles northwest of Washington.

"It's a wilderness atmosphere here and they actually got lost," said Sam Ashelman, co-owner of the 1,500-acre resort. "It got dark Saturday afternoon and they were out hiking, so they had to use Secret Service agents . . . to find their way back down again."

The two were never in danger and they were helped down the trail by agents, Ashelman said Monday.

"It's one of the few places close to Washington where you can get lost and still not get hurt," Ashelman said.

"They have been coming here for the past six years," Ashelman said.

Gore, who wrote a book on the environment, arrived at the resort Saturday morning and left Sunday afternoon.

Welcome & Pot Luck

by Rosemary Bigelow (O-4), Welcome Chair

We have four new owners since the beginning of the year. A welcome visit was held with Bryane and Paul Soni on 3/2, the new owners of H-1. Welcome letters have been sent to Iris Melton, K-12; Nathaniel Shalom and Jamie Hittman, K-4; and Elaine Geiger, L-2. Unfortunately, we cannot hold any welcome visits until the stay at home restrictions are lifted.

The May 9 potluck is canceled. Alternate plans may be made when social gathering restrictions are lifted.

Joining the HOA Board for the Right Reasons

from Kuester Management Group, edited for space



Serving as part of the board for your homeowners association is something to be proud of. It is not a position that everyone is cut out to assume. There is a great deal of responsibility that comes with running an HOA, but also a lot of reward. You get to take part in ensuring the health, value, safety, and continued success of your community. But before you throw your hat in the ring, make sure you're doing so for the right reasons. Here are some practical reasons to run:

You want to better your community. Are you passionate about protecting property value and making improvements that benefit members as a whole? If you are someone who is driven by giving back to others and helping the association to run effectively, board membership may be a good step.

You take problems in stride. Are you someone who remains calm and can deal with stressful situations without losing your cool? Sometimes the board must come up with creative solutions to resolve problems while still maintaining compliance.

You're open to differing viewpoints. There is often more than one "right" way to do something, so board members must be willing to listen to others' opinions and ideas.

You don't need recognition. Being part of the HOA board is often a thankless job. A lot of work goes on behind the scenes that members may not realize.

As part of the HOA board, you'll be on the front lines helping to plan the future and ensure CMA is working in the best interest of owners. If that's something you'd like to be a part of, we welcome you as a candidate in next September's CMA Board election. Contact Rusty McCrady at rusty.mccrady@gmail.com to declare your candidacy.

Get Your Feet Wet

(Continued from page 3.)

Take a Drink

New owners often ask if CMA's water is safe to drink. Yes, you can drink the water that comes out of your tap. WVDOH requires DAILY tests of CMA water by utility operations personnel to verify required chlorine levels are sustained – both at the chlorination station as well as from a random location within the distribution system. In addition, a water sample must be submitted quarterly for analysis by a state-approved independent water testing laboratory to verify the quality of the sample against WVDOH quality metrics. If the sample fails the laboratory test, the WVDOH is authorized to take action that can include shutting down the utility.

How You Can Help

While our system is maintained by volunteers and contractors, our owners have a significant role in the success of the water and sewer systems. You can make a big difference in the cost and efficiency of these systems through a few simple actions:

- Check your home for water leaks: running toilets, dripping faucets, leaking hose bibs
- Repair leaks promptly: call a plumber if needed
- Turn off the water if you plan to be away: flush out pipes when you return
- Pay your utility bill on time: avoid the 10% late fee
- Practice water conservation

It's important to note that Cathy Levey diligently monitors section and resident meters to detect leaks. If you hear from her concerning a possible leak on your side of the water meter, take heed - leaks can grow larger over time. Even a very small leak can lead to the loss of thousands of gallons of water - and a hefty water bill.

You Didn't Cover Sewer

That delicate subject will be addressed in copious detail in the next edition of the CMA Newsletter.

If you have questions or comments about CMA's water system, please contact Cathy Levey at mccm2012@hotmail.com.

To Conserve – Or Not

by Cathy Levey (A-6), Water & Sewer Chair

As we all comply with the governor's stay at home orders, we are currently averaging between 25 to 30 cabins occupied at a time, composed of full timers; part timers choosing to remain in place at their second home; long term renters; and those opting to rent for the required 14-day minimum. As the community quietly awaits the easing of restrictions related to COVID-19, one of the impacts of the reduction in occupancy is to the CMA Water System.

Most of the time, we are reminding owners and others to conserve water, and there are valid reasons for doing so. However, the question is whether this is the best approach during this quieter period.

West Virginia mandates that the water system be monitored and treated with chlorine daily, where a minimum chlorine level at each plant is set by the state health department. In order to ensure that both the North and South Water Systems are adequately chlorinated, we must conduct daily testing and treating, but we also need to be sure that water continues to move through the system. Chlorinated water that sits in stagnant pipes eventually dissipates, resulting in reduced chlorine levels. To avoid this, WSPSD staff and I are flushing each system by way of hydrants. There are five hydrants on each system, and it takes about a half hour to an hour to flush each system. This way, we can maintain adequate chlorine levels even in those sections where occupancy is low.

How can those of you currently in residence be most helpful in relation to our water system? The greatest contribution you can make is to continue to use water in moderation. By continuing to use water responsibly, you help keep water moving through the systems and reduce the need for flushing. This goes a long way to help those who are managing the CMA Water System as we work in cooperation with the owners to ensure a safe and reliable system.

CMA in Bloom









Water Issues?

Warm Springs Public Service District

Weekdays, 9:00 am to 5:00 pm:
304-258-4118

All other times Morgan County non-emergency: 304-258-0305

Provide your name, address, lot number, and the nature of the problem.

Morel Mushrooms – an Appalachian Delicacy

by Eric Lienhard (G-5)

From about mid-April to mid-May many of our residents begin to notice an uptick of cars parked on our roads. The reason for this; it is the peak time for the mushroom hunter to seek out and harvest the popular morel. The morel mushroom is one of West Virginia's renowned delicacies that grows in the wild statewide.

Unauthorized parking on CMA roads is a violation of the covenants and restrictions. Please notify the Site Manager of any violations.

Morels are considered a sac fungi, where the mushroom is the reproductive part of the fungi and contains millions of spores. The main part of the fungi is buried underground. Most hunters use an onion sac when picking mushrooms to allow the spores to disperse as they walk. Although it takes five years for a spore to become a mushroom, once a hunter finds a patch of morels, they typically return year after year, since the right conditions exist. Morels require dense forests, plentiful moisture, the right temperatures and are commonly found around dead or decaying trees.



Although, morels are the most frequently hunted mushroom, they certainly aren't the only edible ones in West Virginia. With that, there are also many inedible and dangerous mushrooms in West Virginia. The two most dangerous types in the region are commonly known as the "death angel" and "funeral bell."

Since West Virginia is home of over 400 species of wild mushrooms, I encourage those interested in learning more about mushrooms to pick up a copy of Bill Roody's, book **Wild Mushrooms of West Virginia and Central Appalachia** (2003).



FETTUCCINE WITH MORELS, LEEKS, & PEAS

Ingredients:

1 lb Fettuccine
½ lb fresh morel mushrooms, chopped
1 medium leek, thinly sliced
1 Tbsp. butter
½ cup ham (cooked/cubed)
½ cup white wine (not the good stuff)
½ cup heavy cream
½ cup chicken stock
1 cup peas (frozen)
1 tsp. fresh or dried thyme

Directions:

- Over medium heat, sauté morels and leeks in butter until tender, approx. 5 min.
- Place mixture into a bowl and set aside.
- Add ham to pan and cook until brown, approx. 5 min. Add wine to deglaze pan.
- Add cream and chicken stock, reduce until sauce coats back of a spoon; approx. 10 min.
- Add moral mixture and remaining ingredients to the pan and cook for another 5 minutes.
- In a large pot of salted water, cook fettuccine according to package directions.
- Drain pasta and return to pot. Add sauce and toss until coated.
- Transfer to serving bowl. Garnish with parsley and shaved Parmesan.

Rules & Regulations: Exterior Maintenance Procedures

All new buildings, additions to existing cottages including, walls, exterior lighting installations, outdoor fireplaces, retaining walls, decks, porches, attached gazebos, or other attached structures to be erected, replaced, repainted or modified require prior written CMA approval. Contact CMA for more information on the procedures involved.

Prior Written CMA Approval: All exterior construction requires the submission for CMA approval of a written plan setting out the specifications, nature, kind, shape, height, materials, color and location of the same. Detailed information on CMA building standards and approval procedures can be obtained from the Association.

Detached Structures: Only a single structure, for residential use, is permitted on each lot. Second, detached, structures such as garages, sheds, tents, etc., are not permitted. Fences are generally discouraged.

Accessory Structures: All accessory structures including decks, trash containers, firewood enclosures, walls and privacy fencing, exterior air conditioners, and antennas are subject to CMA prior approval.

Construction Parking: Temporary construction vehicles, such as dumpsters and mobile construction shelters for non-residential use are permitted with prior written CMA approval.

Easement for Public Utilities: A right-of-way of six feet wide along the perimeter of each lot is reserved and for culverts, pipe lines, sewers, drains, water pipes, telephone lines, and electric conduits and is at all times open to the Association and public utilities serving CMA.

Full document online: CMA Basic Rules

Board Shorts

There was no Board meeting in February.

March 14 Board Meeting

- Appointed Eric Lienhard to the Board, for the remainder of the term, 12/20
- Approved minutes from the Jan 4 W&S and CMA meetings
- Approved W&S Service Termination Letter
- Approved motion for debit card for W&S
- Approved motion to replace wetlands pipe
- Approved motion to replace the CMA sign at Rte 9 and CRValley Rd.
- Appointed Committee chairs for the year
- Approved Resolution 2020-01 for Delinquent Assessment Policy, effective 6/1/20
- Approved motion for Barn Fire Alarm system
- Approved motion for Employee Dishonesty Insurance (Bonding)
- Approved motion for attorney recommended account adjustments

April 4, Executive Session conference call (closed meeting)

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors

Jason Géno, President
Steve Katz, Vice President
Tom Holz, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Sharon Géno, Director
Eric Leinhard, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

Website

www.coolfontmountainside.org
User ID: owner Password: coolfont

Listserv Email

cma-members@googlegroups.com

Listserv Signup/Web

groups.google.com/forum/#!forum/cma-members

Facebook

www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406



COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed by volunteers. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Managers - Holly Malcomb & Jason Schetrompf
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-676-3993

Communications - Dawne Holz
Facebook - Dawne Holz
Google Group - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com
Newsletter - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
Website - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

Firewise - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Infrastructure Mapping - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

Neighborhood Watch - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Social - Holly Malcomb & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-258-9329 kathyk717@aol.com

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Water & Sewer

Chair - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Join the CMA Facebook group!
Search Coolfont Mountainside Association in Facebook groups!

WVHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2020 MEMBER